

Write a Story or Description From the Title Given

You choose the genre and approach. The title must guide everything you write — nothing should feel bolted on.

Name: _____

Date set: _____

Due: _____

YOUR TITLE

"Nobody Noticed the Second Time"

Write a story OR a description inspired by this title. It does not have to appear as a line in your writing, but every reader should be able to see exactly why you chose it once they finish.

This is harder than it looks. A weak answer bolts the title onto a generic story at the last line. A strong answer builds the whole piece — structure, pacing, even the ending — around what the title actually implies: that something happened once already, unnoticed, and now it's happening again.

BEFORE YOU START — PLAN YOUR INTERPRETATION

1. What is "the second time" — the second time what happens? Decide this before writing a single sentence.
2. Who is the "nobody" — is it genuinely nobody, or is there one person who half-notices and dismisses it? That tension is often the strongest angle.
3. Will your reader find out what the "first time" was, or is it left as implication? Both are valid — pick one deliberately.

TECHNIQUE REQUIRED

STRUCTURAL DISCIPLINE

The title's idea must be earned by the structure, not just stated — e.g. an actual repeated event/pattern the reader can trace across the piece, not a single throwaway line explaining it.

Clear beginning → complication/build → ending shape, even in a short piece. No meandering middle.

Your final sentence must connect back to the title without literally repeating its words.

LANGUAGE & TECHNIQUE

At least one example of dramatic irony or situational irony — the reader knows or suspects something a character doesn't (or vice versa).

A mix of long, flowing sentences and short, blunt ones — deliberately, not accidentally.

At least 2 pieces of figurative language (simile, metaphor, or personification) that fit the mood, not decoration for its own sake.

Show restraint with adverbs — replace at least three "-ly" words you'd normally reach for with a stronger verb or image instead.

YOUR WRITING

Checklist — go over it again

1. **Could someone who hasn't seen the title guess it from your ending?** If not, the piece isn't built around it tightly enough yet.
2. Check every character's motivation makes sense — nobody acts a certain way "because the plot needed it."
3. Read the opening and closing paragraphs back to back — do they feel like they belong to the same piece?
4. No clichéd openings ("It was a dark and stormy night," "Little did I know").
5. Punctuation check: commas around interrupting phrases, correct use of ellipsis (not overused for suspense).
6. Paragraphs are used to control pace, not just length — a single-sentence paragraph should be a deliberate choice.